



Sour moment: Lionel Messi in action against Atlanta United, which beat Inter Miami in the deciding leg of their MLS Cup clash. REUTERS

of RB Leipzig in second.

Leipzig wasted the chance to cut down Bayern's lead after being held to a 0-0 draw by Borussia Mönchengladbach.

Borussia Dortmund slipped further down the table and into seventh place after losing 3-1 to FSV Mainz, making it a fourth consecutive defeat on the road this season. Nuri Şahin's side played the majority of the match with 10 men after Emre Can was sent off near the half-hour mark for a reckless challenge.

Defending champion Bayer Leverkusen had a full three points snatched from under its nose after it was held to a 1-1 draw by last-placed VfL Bochum, with Koji Miyoshi (**right**) scoring an 89th-minute equaliser. Despite the result, Leverkusen is still in fourth place, nine points behind

leader Bayern.

Third-placed Eintracht Frankfurt continued its top form in the league after beating VfB Stuttgart 3-2, thanks to goals from Omar Marmoush, Hugo Ekitiké and Nathaniel Brown. After scoring a free-kick in the match, Marmoush is now tied with Harry Kane at the top of the Golden Boot standings with 11 goals.

MLS

After a record-breaking regular season, Inter Miami's bid to win the MLS Cup came to a halt as it lost 3-2 to Atlanta United in the third and deciding leg of round one of the post-season.

The first leg of the three-match series ended 2-1 in Inter Miami's favour, while the scoreline was reversed in the second leg.

Matías Rojas gave Miami the lead, but Atlanta responded immediately

through Jamal Thiaré, who scored twice in two minutes. Atlanta goalkeeper Brad Guzan frustrated the home side with save after save before Lionel Messi headed the ball in from close range to equalise.

However, just over 10 minutes after the leveller, the Inter Miami defence was caught out once again as Bartosz Slisz leapt into the air to head the ball in off an inviting cross from defender Pedro Amador.



AFP